

KYLE GAARDER

Community Builder | Sales & Relationships | Event Programming

📞 720-232-6836 @ kylegaarder@gmail.com linkedin.com/in/kylegaarder 📍 Austin, Texas

SUMMARY

Community builder and relationship-driven seller. Closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals, achieving 46% YoY revenue growth. I bring both the community instinct and the sales hustle - building programming that attracts members and relationships that keep them.

EXPERIENCE

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

- 📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX
- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching
 - 100% occupancy before lease start
 - Designed community programming that drove 94% occupancy
 - retention for 19 consecutive months
 - Ran 48 weekly community dinners, 4 masterminds, and 6 work-trade programs from scratch
 - Built onboarding and engagement loops converting new members into long-term residents
 - Executed A/B pricing experiments driving 48% revenue lift while maintaining community quality
 - Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY
 - across community and facility ops
 - Facilitated smooth acquisition transition while maintaining member trust and community identity

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

- 📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR
- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots
 - community outreach
 - Conducted 48 customer interviews to understand member needs and community preferences
 - Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
 - Led community sales and membership growth across strategy, ops, and programming

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

- 📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA
- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
 - Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
 - Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
 - Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
 - Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 💎

30-40 Clients per Summer
Closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach, referrals, and relationships
- 💎

46% YoY Revenue Growth
Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth through pricing, operations, and service
- 💎

94% Retention via Community
Community-driven programming sustained 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months
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Investor Pilot Secured
Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community concept across 5 states
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Demand Pipeline Built
Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

- Community Sales
- Event Programming
- Membership Growth
- Relationship-Driven Sales
- Direct Outreach Referrals
- Engagement & Retention Events
- Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

- Bachelors in Science, Biology**
Virginia Tech

📅 08/2010 - 05/2014
📍 Virginia, USA
 - Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish

GPA
3.5 / 4.0